



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 38

OREGON

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Oregon's family courts and child-welfare system.

42

OREGON FAMILIES ON RECORD · 58
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 26, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
14 OF 36

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

OREGON AT A GLANCE.

Across 42 Oregon families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 58 42 of 42 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$5,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 18 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 59.5% 38.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 42	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.4	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 42 of 42	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 14

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Oregon families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF OREGON FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	29	\$5,000	\$95,666	\$2,774,300
Lost Wages	27	\$15,000	\$104,263	\$2,815,100
Other Court Fees	24	\$800	\$11,567	\$277,600
Therapy / Evaluations	23	\$0	\$4,783	\$110,000
Reunification Services	22	\$0	\$1,195	\$26,300
GAL Fees	22	\$0	\$7,932	\$174,500
Asset Loss ¹	23	\$12,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$32,800	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$12,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		18 1.5 yrs
Mean months lost		35 2.9 yrs
Total across all families		1,049 87.4 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · OREGON

Most families documenting in Oregon are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Not provided		21	50%
Active case: stuck or delayed		14	33%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		6	14%
Case closed: within last 2 years		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		22	52%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		7	17%
Family Court Only		7	17%
Unknown		6	14%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		11	26%
5 – 10 years		9	21%
Over 10 years		8	19%
3 – 5 years		4	10%
5+ years		3	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		15	36%
Visitation Only		15	36%
Full Custody		4	10%
50/50 Joint		4	10%
Children in Foster Care		3	7%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Umatilla		2	5%
Lane		2	5%
Douglas		2	5%
Klamath		2	5%
Lincoln		1	2%
Deschutes		1	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		12	29%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		9	21%
Other: (Short answer)		5	12%
High Conflict Divorce		5	12%
Medical CPS (Medical Child Abuse allegations, disagreement with doctors)		3	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — OREGON

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Let a mom get temporary full custody of kids with dad only getting supervised visits for false accusations when the judge didn't look to see she has a history of making false accusations to cps

— JESSICA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

False accusations without due process. Unable to appeal without upheld letter from district office.

— OREGON PARENT · PAUL

MORE VOICES FROM OREGON

The failed court system has destroyed my children's childhood, removed them from their family, and placed them with founded abusers

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed mu family .I lost everything .

— DWAN

Destroyed. They ruined a very happy family. Knowing better.

— ERIC

The system has silenced my son and I.

— ELISE

Follow all they want me to do but keep making up false accusations to push out my case and trying to adopt out my youngest

— STEPHANIE

Traumatized, destroyed, took everything 3x over, PTSD, depression, anxiety, panic attacks, nightmares, rage, anger, pain, heartache, missed time that can't get back

— TAMI

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It has destroyed my family and extinguished all trust in our system.

— KRYSTAAL

The judge refused to acknowledge that I was a child and my ex was an adult. Because they decided to give 50/50 custody he abused and molested my child.

— EUNICE

Giving my Grand- baby to the ex- abuser in a drug rehab center as a patient, for 4 to 6months, reading my false Positives as Positive, following the miss leading statements and false accusations . Not following or recognizing the ICWA Law

— SHIELA

I had a child that was a runaway had 2 children and continued to be a runaway until she was 19 my other children have psychological problems and addiction problems because of the abuse during permanent foster I have 4 children 3 of those children now currently live with me as [...]

— KATHIE

It is psychologically messing up my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son is currently a competent and clear 13 year old young man who is speaking out about the current abuse he is experiencing, he tried to fire his attorney with a letter to her and she tired to bury and spun lies about it. The system of family court has only protected the [...]

— CORA

Killed my 14 year old daughter and alienation from my 19 year old

— KELLY

Made be bitter, afraid of relationship, reclusive, non trusting of others

— GREG

It has tore out family apart due to false alligations as well as interfere with parenting and parenting time along with teaching my kids that I'm poor and can't provide for them which is untrue

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Drastically changed our lives on hear say allegations with no due process knowing for a long while the other parent has had issues in the past but allowing what the false accusations to stick and ignore parental alienation and so much precious time stolen away that my son have [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destruction beyond repair. They kidnapped our lives. Ruined them.

— ERIC

This system has destroyed the bonds that I had with my daughters and I have been fighting to get them back but feel like I'm barely hanging on to them.

— TARALEE

Disabled me in 2016 social security didn't find me disabled in 2020 I'm legally disabled from trauma symptoms. Child lost love respect communication. I never gambled before in my life until I attempted to retain funds for a lawyer my life changed dramatic pains suffering. I [...]

— NICOLE

This system failed to protect my child and instead prolonged harm, rewarded dysfunction, and forced my family into years of trauma and financial devastation while I fought simply to remain in my child's life.

— LAUREN

Took all my boys away from me and sold my last child at birth

— MINUETT

Stole my child from a family friends home, I wasn't present and never got to even say goodbye. No due process whatsoever.. I haven't seen or spoken to my child since. She was 8 at the time and is now going to be 10 in April.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have cameras all around my house now. I checked my front door every morning for a CPS card. My son doesn't go to school. We listen completely isolation. I am a mom with 27 cases with the state of Oregon. Only four founded. Yet I live in complete fear every single day. I have a [...]

— ATHENA

Destroyed it, they helped my abuser knowing he was abusive because I have anxiety they told me my mental health was worse but I wasn't even admitted to the hospital for my anxiety and was on no medication and was seeing a counselor and doctor for my anxiety. The courts decided [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Filed Modification September 2023 and had 2 day hearing March 2026, didn't finish so have another day in May 2026. Legal system delayed due to lack of judicial resources and ex husband delayed 2 prior dates for a hearing as a tactic.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has helped my mother to a degree but made her way worse, it help me as a child from her. My grandparents saved me. It helped me get my mom help. Just wish I could have done more for them all before it was too late bi miss them sooo.

— ANGELA

Family court has caused me to lose hope in America, my future, & my kids future. It took the happiest parts of me and turned them to dust. They stole things I can't replace. Time. Memories. My God-given blessing of motherhood. My child. What is more devastating than losing a [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system that was meant to protect and serve my family instead became a long, exhausting battle that tested my strength, strained mine and my son's bond for many years, and forced me and my son to endure far more than we ever should have had to.

— JULIE

As mentally and emotionally drained me makes me walk on eggshells they have taken the good parent and bash them to the ground Sidenote in your cost estimates, I tried filling it out and every which way I did it it would put red letters so that part on my survey is incorrect

— TABITHA

Nothing except undue stress

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

32 Oregon parents submitted ranked quotes. 32 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/or.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Oregon report comes from Oregon respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Oregon — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 42 Oregon families reporting here are not the universe of Oregon families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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